The armed forces have the luxury of not fighting wars on most days, and have developed a sound culture of enormous training schedules that run all through the year. In other parts of government, training tends to be short-changed in an environment of crisis management. This is a vicious cycle: weak institutions are engulfed in crisis management, and cut corners in training, which engenders institutional weakness.

Once a policymaker decides that an expressway must be built, everyone is comfortable that it will take *n* number of years before the expressway is inaugurated. In similar fashion, once it has been decided that a new organization like the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) will be built, everyone should be comfortable that this will take two years before it can be inaugurated. [5]

Administrative law to the fore

In Indian public policy, it is exciting to work on inflation targeting or net neutrality or Nifty futures trading in Singapore. A great fraction of conference time is devoted to political economy, to painting the map of interests and envisaging grand bargains.

Administrative law is considered the dull backwater, that should concern junior bureaucrats only. However, we think that the cutting edge of building state capacity lies in the dry detail of formal processes, rules, and checks and balances, in the subject of administrative law.

Clean slate versus reforming an existing organization

The material of this chapter readily fits into the challenge of building a brand-new organization. But most of the machinery of the Indian state is already in place. A great deal of bad decisions and the wrong political economy are now in play.